



Cloud & IoT Monitoring and Data analysis with Elasticsearch and Grafana

Personal Reflection

Bachelor's degree in the Applied Computer
Science

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1. Introduction

The following personal reflection shares the main insights I gained during my internship at Van Genechten Packaging. The internship experience revealed professional workplace dynamics while helping me understand my abilities and weaknesses, as well as my reactions to obstacles. My practical expertise surpassed academic learning by providing me with valuable skills that increased my confidence. I developed my problem-solving abilities, and improved my communication and teamwork competencies. The internship experience taught me about patience, resilience, and feedback receptiveness, which proved essential for my personal and professional growth.

2. Personal Development and Growth

My internship at Van Genechten Packaging offered me significant opportunities for personal growth. My first experience working in a real company environment gave me direct responsibility for contributing to its operations, which boosted my confidence. I learned to adapt to professional settings by managing expectations and communicating clearly, all while staying flexible in uncertain situations.

The key lesson I learned was that technical expertise alone does not guarantee success because success requires both patience and persistence, along with a willingness to accept feedback. Progress sometimes felt slow as I faced uncertainty about my next steps, but I learned to break work into smaller parts and celebrate small wins. This method improved my ability to recover from setbacks and boosted my confidence.

3. Competencies Acquired

Personal and Professional Skills

Problem-Solving and Adaptability:

The lack of clear tasks and insufficient data created multiple situations that made me uncertain about my next steps. I learned to handle these obstacles through patient and adaptable methods instead of feeling discouraged. I started asking detailed, well-structured questions to my supervisor for clarification and sought help whenever I encountered a roadblock. Through this proactive approach, I avoided getting stuck while building better problem-solving skills. I learned to stay calm when faced with uncertainty because I understood it as an essential part of real-world work instead of something to fear. Over time, I developed greater confidence in my ability to work with incomplete information while breaking down complex tasks and devising effective strategies.

Critical Thinking:

I learned to identify crucial elements in tasks and focus on essential aspects instead of getting distracted by excessive details. I discovered that trying to solve everything at once was ineffective, so I learned to break problems into smaller sections that I could handle one at a time while concentrating on key project goals. This new way of thinking helped me reduce unnecessary stress and improve my time management skills. I was able to make significant progress by concentrating on essential objectives, even when some parts were unclear or incomplete. My ability to distinguish critical elements from less important details developed into a skill that boosted my confidence when handling complex work and created a more organized and meaningful approach to my work tasks.

Collaboration and Communication:

My supervisor's close collaboration enabled me to enhance my presentation skills for both ideas and progress. I developed better skills to present my thoughts effectively while paying attention to feedback and modifying my work according to the guidance I received. The direct communication experience showed me how essential it is to remain open-minded and adaptable when working in a professional environment.

Soft Skills Growth

Built better resilience when things did not work out right away:

Sometimes, my first attempts didn't produce the results I hoped for, which could have been discouraging. Instead of seeing these setbacks as failures, I started to view them as chances to learn and grow. This change in mindset helped me build resilience, teaching me to keep going through difficulties and stay motivated even when progress was slow.

Learned to break down my work into smaller steps and celebrate progress:

I realized that trying to solve a task all at once often felt overwhelming. By breaking my work into manageable steps, I could see my progress more clearly and lessen stress. Celebrating small wins along the way boosted my morale and helped me keep momentum, even when working on more complex or time-consuming assignments.

Built confidence in my abilities by seeing how I could contribute to a real company setting:

Working in a professional environment allowed me to apply my skills practically and see how they could make a difference. This experience boosted my confidence in my abilities and reassured me that I can use what I have learned in real-world situations. It also encouraged me to trust my own judgment and approach problems more confidently.

4. Challenges Faced

Unclear Expectations: I had difficulty at the beginning because some instructions or goals were vague. It was frustrating, but it taught me the importance of asking for clarification and not being afraid to request more details.

Incomplete Work: There were times when I could not fully complete a task because of missing information. Instead of viewing this as a failure, I realized that such limitations are common in real work environments and that progress is still valuable even when the outcome is not perfect.

Balancing Pressure and Learning: Sometimes I felt the pressure to deliver results quickly, but I learned that taking time to understand the problem thoroughly leads to better results and less stress.

5. Suggestions for Improvement

The internship process includes several areas that need improvement to strengthen future intern support and build confidence from the start.

The internship process would benefit from the early setting of specific goals and expectations, which would give interns clear responsibilities and job security. Measuring progress would also become easier when these goals and expectations are established at the start of the internship.

A brief introductory training session on company tools, processes, and workflows should be provided at the start to help interns adjust more quickly and begin contributing effectively.

The value of regular informal check-ins would grow for interns because these sessions help them verify their progress and address challenges they face. The combination of early mistake correction through feedback allows interns to build confidence when their progress is acknowledged.

The proposed suggestions aim to enhance the existing valuable internship program through better guidance for new interns and improved learning opportunities.

5. Conclusion

The internship experience proved essential for my growth as a person and professional. The internship provided me with the chance to link academic learning to practical work experience while simultaneously developing my personal development.

The experience taught me to become more confident and resilient while showing me how to handle professional challenges. The most important lesson I learned is that learning continues throughout someone's career. I made significant progress but realized that there is always room for improvement. The approach to lifelong learning I developed will guide my professional journey and turn every new challenge into an opportunity for personal growth.

